HNB YOUTH SAVINGS ACCOUNT

1. What is the HNB Youth account?

The HNB Youth Savings Account is a savings product designed for young adults. It encourages young people to develop good savings habits while providing banking facilities that support their financial needs.

Key details to mention:

- **Target age group:** 18–30 years.
- **Opening deposit:** Rs. 2,000, according to HNB's published product information.
- **Digital banking:** Internet and mobile banking facilities.
- **Debit card:** An HNB Youth-branded debit card.
- **Additional benefits:** Selected loan facilities, credit-card benefits and special offers, subject to the bank's terms and eligibility requirements.

2. What are the main benefits of HNB Youth?

You can explain the benefits under four main categories.

A. Encourages saving habits

Young people can start saving money from their first salary, allowance or business income.

For example, a young person who saves Rs. 3,000 every month can develop financial discipline and gradually build savings for future needs.

B. Digital convenience

Internet and mobile banking facilities make it easier for eligible customers to access banking services without visiting a branch for every transaction.

This is particularly useful for students and young professionals who prefer digital services.

C. Financial support for future goals

Subject to eligibility and the bank's applicable terms, young customers may benefit from selected lending facilities as their needs develop.

For example, they may eventually need financial assistance for education, a vehicle or housing.

D. Lifestyle benefits

The account may provide selected offers and other benefits designed for young customers.

These benefits can make the account more attractive to young people who want value beyond basic savings.

3. Why is HNB Youth important to the bank?

This is an excellent point to include because it shows your understanding of the banking business.

HNB Youth is not only about opening savings accounts. It is also an opportunity to build long-term customer relationships.

There are three main reasons.

1. **Customer acquisition:** The bank can attract young customers at the beginning of their financial journeys.
2. **Cross-selling opportunities:** As customers' needs develop, the bank can introduce relevant products such as fixed deposits, credit cards and eligible loan facilities.
3. **Customer loyalty:** Providing a positive banking experience early can encourage customers to maintain their relationship with HNB for many years.

For example, a customer who opens an HNB Youth account at age 20 may later become a salary account holder, a fixed deposit customer or a borrower.

Therefore, attracting young customers can support the bank's long-term business growth.

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PART 2: COMPARISON OF YOUTH ACCOUNTS WITH OTHER BANKS

For a meaningful comparison, let's consider HNB Youth and two competing products: Seylan Seylfie and Commercial Bank Dotcom.

Hatton National Bank, Seylan Bank and Commercial Bank of Ceylon all serve customers with different banking needs.

1. HNB Youth vs Seylan Seylfie

Seylan Bank offers the Seylan Seylfie youth savings product.

Feature	**HNB Youth**	**Seylan Seylfie**
Main purpose	Youth savings and wider banking benefits	Youth savings with digital and lifestyle-oriented features
Target age	18–30 years, according to HNB's published information	Check the current Seylan product terms
Opening deposit	Rs. 2,000, according to published HNB information	Check the current Seylan product terms
Digital banking	Internet and mobile banking facilities	Digital banking features
Additional value	Selected card, lending and lifestyle benefits	Youth-focused rewards and benefits, subject to current terms

How should you explain this comparison?

HNB Youth focuses on encouraging savings while offering access to a wider range of banking benefits.

Seylan Seylfie also targets young customers and emphasises features designed to appeal to digitally engaged youth.

Our comparison should not simply identify which bank offers more benefits. We should identify which product best meets the needs of each customer.

For example, a customer interested in future lending options may value one set of features, while another customer may prioritise digital convenience and special offers.

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2. HNB Youth vs Commercial Bank Dotcom

Commercial Bank of Ceylon offers the Dotcom savings product for young customers.

When comparing these products, examine the following areas:

Feature	HNB Youth	Commercial Bank Dotcom
Main focus	Youth savings and broader banking benefits	Youth savings and product-specific benefits
Digital facilities	Internet and mobile banking	Check the current facilities offered
Debit card	HNB Youth-branded debit card	Check the current card facilities
Special benefits	Selected card, lending and lifestyle benefits	Check the current product offers
Best comparison point	Range of banking services and benefits	Features specifically designed for its target customers

: HOW CAN WE MAKE HNB YOUTH MORE ATTRACTIVE?

This is the section that can really help your group demonstrate its understanding of banking.

Instead of only describing the product, explain how HNB could attract more young customers.

1. University and campus promotions

HNB could organise promotional campaigns at universities and higher education institutions.

For example:

- Introduce the account to university students.
- Explain the importance of saving from an early age.
- Provide clear information about account-opening requirements.
- Demonstrate digital banking facilities.

Expected benefit: Increase awareness and attract eligible young customers.

2. Promote the account through social media

Young people frequently use social media to discover products and services.

HNB could create short videos explaining the account's benefits, digital facilities and savings tips.

For example, a campaign could encourage young customers to save a small amount every month towards a personal goal.

4. Encourage salary account conversions

Young people entering employment are an important customer segment.

HNB could promote suitable banking packages to young employees and explain the benefits of maintaining a salary account alongside their savings goals.

Expected benefit: Build longer-term relationships with customers at the beginning of their careers.

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PART 4: WHAT SHOULD WE COMPARE WHEN EVALUATING YOUTH ACCOUNTS?

To make your comparison more professional, consider these six factors.

Factor	Why it matters
Interest rate	Helps customers understand the return on their savings.
Opening deposit	Determines how much money is required to open an account.
Minimum balance	Helps customers understand whether they must maintain a certain balance.
Digital facilities	Shows how conveniently customers can access banking services.
Card benefits and charges	Helps customers understand card facilities and associated costs.
Additional benefits	Shows whether the account provides relevant offers or other services.

A useful point to make: A higher interest rate does not automatically mean an account is better. Customers should also consider fees, minimum-balance requirements, accessibility and other benefits.

When comparing interest rates, make sure you use the same date and account conditions for all banks.

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PART 5: YOUR STRONGEST CONCLUSION

Here is the main message your group should communicate:

HNB Youth is more than a savings account. It is an opportunity for young customers to begin their financial journeys with HNB.

By comparing competing products, the bank can better understand what young customers value and identify opportunities to improve its offering.

The key is to combine attractive benefits, digital convenience, financial education and excellent customer service.